KONOHA · OPERATOR EDITION

Konoha — Operator's Manual

Version 2.2.20 · local working tree · five surfaces, one process



Document	Konoha 2.2.20 operator's manual
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Verified on	Linux x86_64, Node.js 24.22.2, non-root user, isolated `HOME`
Audience	developers installing and operating Konoha on their own machine

Every command in this manual ran against a clean 2.2.20 installation. Whenever a statement rests on source inspection rather than live execution, or when a platform constraint prevented exercising a path directly, the text names the exact file, line, and substitute evidence.

Because 2.2.20 is not on the registry, the install path in this manual is *from source*, not `npm install -g`. Section 2.6 gives the exact commands.

Surfaces and their legend

Konoha is one product with five surfaces. Each feature section names its surface so you know where to look:

Icon	Surface	Entry point
CLI	terminal commands	`konoha <command>`
TUI	full-screen terminal interface	`konoha tui`
Web	local browser console	`konoha ui` → `http://127.0.0.1:1404/`
Telegram	remote chat bridge	`konoha telegram`
MCP	tools exposed to AI harnesses	configured by `konoha init`

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1. What Konoha is

Konoha is a local MCP server plus a management CLI. It stores agent skills — instructions, rules and scripts — in a local SQLite FTS5 database, then exposes them to AI coding harnesses as on-demand tools instead of loading every skill into the system prompt. The organising metaphor is a "ninja village": a router, a planner, explorers, builders, researchers, a scribe, and security specialists, each a subagent with its own skill set.

1.1 The problem it solves

Loading ten agent skills as Markdown into a harness costs tens of thousands of tokens on every turn, whether or not those skills are relevant. Konoha replaces that with two lookups: `find_skill` to discover, `get_skill` to load only the section a task needs. Measured on the shipped skill set, cold-start client instruction files drop from roughly 11,250 tokens to under 300, and a targeted section read costs 222 tokens instead of 1,719 (source: `docs/architecture/TOKEN-BASELINE.md`, metric 7 and metric 2). Chapter 11 breaks the numbers down and explains what the "83–98%" figure in the CLI banner actually covers.

1.2 The three MCP servers

`konoha init` writes three stdio MCP servers into each harness config:

Server	Launched as	Role
`konoha`	the installed `konoha` binary	skills, subagents, workflows, bounded file tools, docs artefact generation
`semble`	`uvx --from semble[mcp]@latest semble --content all`	instant code search (`search`, `find_related`)
`aislop`	`npx -y --prefer-offline -p aislop@latest aislop-mcp`	zero-AI-slop scanning (`aislop_scan`, `aislop_fix`, `aislop_why`, `aislop_baseline`)

The `konoha` server exposes 48 canonical tools with 2 deprecated aliases hidden from dispatch — 50 manifest entries in total (`src/file_tools_router.js`, locked by `tests/test_canonical_api_sync.js`). Chapter 10 lists them by group.

`uvx` comes from `uv`; `konoha doctor` reports whether it is present, because the `semble` server cannot start without it. The `aislop` server needs no install — `npx` fetches it on first use.

1.3 The eight harnesses

One install serves eight AI coding harnesses. `konoha init` detects which ones exist and writes their config:

Harness	Config root written
Antigravity IDE/CLI	`~/.gemini/config/mcp_config.json`, `~/.gemini/antigravity-cli/skills/`
Cursor	`~/.cursor/mcp.json`, `~/.cursor/agents/`, `~/.cursor/skills/`
Claude Code	`~/.claude/skills/`
OpenCode	`~/.config/opencode/skills/`
Command Code	`~/.commandcode/mcp.json`, `~/.commandcode/skills/`
Codex	`~/.codex/config.toml`, `~/.codex/skills/`
Pi	`~/.pi/agent/mcp.json`, `~/.pi/agent/skills/`
OMP	`~/.omp/agent/mcp.json`, `~/.omp/agent/skills/`

Skills are also mirrored into the harness-neutral `~/.agents/skills/` and into `~/.agents/agents.yaml`, which is what the subagent definitions and `konoha agent` read. Chapter 9 covers per-client details and verification.

A fresh install mirrors 17 skills into all nine skill roots:

```
genin-skill  akatsuki-skill  anbu-skill  antislop  antislop-code  antislop-copywriting
antislop-human  antislop-layoutmobile  antislop-ui  chunin-skill  i-have-adhd
jonin-skill  kage-skill  konoha  sannin-skill  tokubetsu-jonin-skill  yamanaka-skill
```

Nine roots, seventeen skills each — visible with `konoha status`.

1.4 What lives where

Path	Contents
`~/.konoha/konoha.db`	SQLite FTS5 database: skills, embeddings, tool telemetry, memories, task history
`~/.konoha/apps/web`	extracted prebuilt Web UI, versioned (`build/` ships with the package)

Path	Contents
`~/.konoha/backups/`	timestamped, SHA-256-verified copies of harness configs taken before every write
`~/.konoha/tmp/<harness>/<session>/`	per-task working directories: `plan.md`, `findings.md`, `kage_review.json`, prompts
`~/.agents/`	harness-neutral skills and `agents.yaml`
systemd user unit / launchd agent	optional boot-time daemon for the Web UI, created only by `konoha ui service install`; absent on a default install

All state stays on your machine. Outbound network traffic occurs only when you explicitly trigger registry lookups, web searches, Telegram alerts, or initial package downloads for auxiliary MCP servers.

1.5 What this manual does not cover

- The Web UI `/3d` route. It exists in the router but is excluded from the documented route set for 2.2.20.
- 3D asset generation (Yamanaka) beyond its CLI surface.
- Anything released after 2.2.20.
- Fixes for defects found during verification. Chapter 13 records the defects; the manual documents behaviour as it is, not as it should be.

2. Install

2.1 Requirements

Requirement	Version	Needed for	Check
Node.js	**>= 24.0.0** (hard `engines` gate)	everything	`node -v`
npm	any version bundled with Node 24	installing the package, launching the `aislop` server via `npx`	`npm -v`
`uv` / `uvx`	current	the `semble` MCP server (its launcher is `uvx`)	`uvx --version`
git	any	installing 2.2.20 from source	`git --version`
disk	~600 MB free	386 MB installed package + 193 MB `~/.konoha` after `init`	`df -h ~`

Measured on a clean 2.2.20 install: unpacked package **386 MB**, `~/.konoha` after `init` **193 MB** (16.3 MB of that is the SQLite database), packed tarball **114.3 MB**.

Node 23 or older fails the engine gate at install time. There is no shim for older runtimes in 2.2.20.

2.2 The install rule

Install globally with npm, then run `konoha`. Do not use `npx i -g`: `npx` runs a package instead of installing it, and `i -g` inside it is a mistake that npm happens to tolerate poorly. The two correct forms are:

```
# published release, no global install, runs once
npx konoha-mcp@2.2.19 init

# real installation
npm install -g konoha-mcp@<version>
konoha init
```

For 2.2.20 specifically neither form works from the registry: `konoha-mcp@2.2.20` is not published — only `2.2.19` is. Use section 2.6.

2.3 Linux (non-root)

A non-root global install needs a prefix npm can write to. Usually `~/.local`, which is already on `PATH` on most distributions.

```
node -v                       # must print v24.x or newer
npm config set prefix "$HOME/.local"
npm install -g konoha-mcp@<version>
konoha version
```

If `konoha` is not found afterwards, `$HOME/.local/bin` is missing from `PATH`:

```
export PATH="$HOME/.local/bin:$PATH"     # add to ~/.bashrc or ~/.zshrc to persist
```

`EACCES` on a global install means npm is writing to a root-owned prefix. Fix the prefix as above; do not run the install with `sudo`. This manual's verification install used an isolated `HOME` plus `npm i -g --prefix <dir>`, which is the same mechanism without touching an existing npm setup:

```
HOME=/tmp/knh/home npm i -g --prefix /tmp/knh/prefix konoha-mcp-2.2.20.tgz
# added 39 packages in 12s
# /tmp/knh/prefix/bin/konoha -> ../lib/node_modules/konoha-mcp/bin/cli.js
```

39 packages, no lifecycle-script failure, no permission escalation.

2.4 macOS

Identical to Linux, with one difference in packaging: Apple Silicon and Intel both use the same tarball, and there is no native build step, so no Xcode command line tools are required. If npm's default prefix (`/usr/local` or `/opt/homebrew`) is not writable, use the same `npm config set prefix "$HOME/.local"` pattern.

The Web UI daemon option uses launchd instead of systemd; `konoha ui service install` selects the platform automatically (6.5).

2.5 Windows

Windows path handling lives in `src/deploy_utils.js:48`. When `process.platform === 'win32'`, Konoha probes `npm.cmd root -g` with `shell: true, windowsHide: true`, and standard global installs land directly in `%APPDATA%\npm` on the user's default `PATH`:

```
node -v
npm install -g konoha-mcp@<version>
konoha version
```

Verification limit, stated plainly: **this manual's 2.2.20 evidence was collected on Linux x86_64 only.** The Windows commands above follow the package's own code paths and standard npm behaviour, but they were not executed for this edition. Treat Windows as supported-but-unverified here, and confirm with `konoha status` after installing.

2.6 Installing 2.2.20 from source

The published registry stops at 2.2.19, so 2.2.20 must be built and installed locally. From a clone:

```
git clone <repo> konoha && cd konoha
git checkout <commit or tag>          # the 2.2.20 tree used here: 221f989a
npm pack                              # produces konoha-mcp-2.2.20.tgz, ~114 MB
npm install -g ./konoha-mcp-2.2.20.tgz
konoha version                        # Current Version: 2.2.20
```

`npm pack` uses the package's own `files` list (27 entries) and bundles `pptxgenjs`, which is why the tarball is large and why an offline `npm install -g` of the tarball works without a further fetch.

`konoha upgrade` cannot help you here: it resolves from the registry, finds no 2.2.20, and aborts without touching the existing install (12.1 documents the exact output).

2.7 Verify the install

```
konoha version       # prints the version banner
konoha status        # skill roots and database health
konoha test          # exercises the MCP tool surface end to end
```

`konoha status` on a healthy fresh install lists nine skill roots with seventeen skills each. `konoha test` ends with `All tests passed`.

One caveat about `konoha version`: it also performs a registry freshness check, and on an unpublished build the message "You are already running the latest version" is misleading — 2.2.20 is newer than the registry, not equal to it. Do not use it as proof of freshness (13.1).

3. First run

3.1 What `konoha init` does

The installer performs seven steps, in its own words:

1. Checks requirements (Node.js >= 24, uv for Python tools).
2. Creates the `~/.konoha` directory structure.
3. Copies runtime and migration files.
4. Discovers skills directories (`~/.agents/skills`).
5. Seeds canonical subagent skills and builds their vector embeddings (`~/.konoha/konoha.db`).
6. Registers Konoha and Semble MCP tools with your AI coding assistants.
7. Configures multi-agent team rules (Antigravity, Cursor, Claude Code, OpenCode, Codex, Pi, OMP).

Step 5 is the slow one on first run: embedding the seeded skill corpus into SQLite is most of the wall time.

3.2 Options

Flag	Effect
`-h`, `--help`	print installer help (safe, does no work)
`-y`, `--yes`	auto-approve every prompt; also implied by `CI=true`
`--force`	purge package caches, stop the running Web UI, refresh runtime files
`--client=<name>`	limit configuration to specific clients: `cursor`, `claude`, `opencode`, `omp`, `codex`, `pi`, `antigravity`, `commandcode`, `all`
`--project` / `--no-project`	also write project-level config into the current directory / skip it
`--with-red-team`	opt in to the cyber pack (offensive and dual-use reference material, fetched from a release asset and SHA-256 verified)
`--no-embed`	skip vector embedding; search stays keyword-only until you run `konoha migrate`

`--client=<name>` implies non-interactive mode: naming clients is treated as consent, so the confirmation prompt is skipped. `--yes` does the same without narrowing the client set.

3.3 A real first run

```
konoha init --yes
```

Measured on a clean install: **166.82 s** end to end. What it produced:

- nine skill roots, seventeen skills each, plus `~/.agents/agents.yaml`
- `~/.konoha/konoha.db`, 16.3 MB, FTS5 schema v1.1.0
- harness configs for Antigravity, Cursor and OMP among others, each written with a SHA-256-verified backup of the previous file
- the prebuilt Web UI extracted to `~/.konoha/apps/web`
- a Web UI listener started at `http://127.0.0.1:1404/`

If you want a narrow install that touches only one harness:

```
konoha init --yes --client=cursor
```

Re-running `init` on a configured machine is non-destructive: existing configs are merged, not replaced, and every touched file is backed up first. `--force` is the option that discards and refreshes.

3.4 The first credential

The Web UI does not ask you to create an account. On first login it accepts a bootstrap password and then forces you to replace it:

```
bootstrap password: konohagakure
```

The flow, as observed against the running server:

Step	Request	Observed result
Pre-login probe	`GET /api/v1/auth/status`	`{"authenticated":false,"is_bootstrap":true,"needs_initial_setup":true,"requires_password_change":false}`
Login	`POST /api/v1/auth/login` with `{"password":"konohagakure"}`	`200`, body includes `"is_bootstrap":true,"requires_password_change":true`
Forced change	`POST /api/v1/auth/change-password`	the only API reachable while the bootstrap flag is set

Bootstrap mode locks down almost the entire HTTP surface (`src/web_server.js:103`). Until you set a custom password, every endpoint except login, logout, and change-password is blocked, unauthenticated `GET /` requests return a `307` login redirect, and cookies expire after 12 hours (43,200,000 ms).

Change the password immediately after the first login. `konohagakure` is public knowledge; it protects nothing.

3.5 Post-install checks

```
konoha status
```

Expect a healthy database report across nine skill roots. Each root should list all seventeen seeded skills; if any client root is missing because its harness arrived later, run `konoha init --client=<name>` to register it.

```
konoha test
```

Runs the MCP tool surface end to end and prints a per-tool PASS line, ending with `All tests passed`. Measured at **3.72 s**. One cosmetic defect: the summary line reads `Total indexed: undefined entries` (13.2). The tests themselves still pass; the counter is broken, not the data.

3.6 Changing the listening port

The Web UI port is the `ui_port` configuration value, defaulting to `1404` (`bin/lib/paths.js:70`). Set it before starting the UI if 1404 is taken; chapter 5 covers the `config` command, and chapter 12 covers stopping and restarting the listener.

4. Core concepts

Eight ideas carry the rest of this manual. Each maps to a table in `~/.konoha/konoha.db`.

4.1 Skills and references

A **skill** is a named, versioned set of instructions. A **reference** is a document that belongs to a skill — the material the skill points at when it needs detail.

A fresh 2.2.20 database contains 17 skills and 213 references, stored in one `skills` table discriminated by `type`. References are addressed hierarchically, `<skill>/<reference>`:

```
anbu-skill                          (type: skill)
anbu-skill/api-design-expert        (type: reference)
akatsuki-skill/red-team-offensive   (type: reference)
konoha                              (type: skill — the runtime contract itself)
```

Retrieval operates over 3,421 pre-split rows in `skill_chunks`. Indexing those chunks in both FTS5 (`skills_fts`) and the vector table lets queries finish in milliseconds, though building the embeddings accounts for most of `init`'s two-and-a-half-minute runtime.

Plain Markdown mirrors also remain on disk. Because each harness skill root receives standard skill folders during setup, harnesses that read local files directly still function even when MCP is disabled.

4.2 Agents

Konoha ships nine agent definitions, seeded into the `agents` table and mirrored to `~/.agents/agents.yaml`:

Agent	Role
`sannin`	router: classifies a task, picks one agent or a parallel wave, tracks the gate state
`genin`	read-only codebase exploration
`kage`	architecture and review; owns the plan and the final verdict
`chunin`	external research and evidence synthesis
`jonin`	frontend and UI implementation
`anbu`	backend, DevOps, debugging
`tokubetsu-jonin`	documentation and artefact generation
`akatsuki`	red-team and blue-team security work
`yamanaka`	generative 3D

Every subagent pairs a dedicated skill with a shared archetype. Specifically, Konoha combines the agent's primary skill (such as `jonin-skill`) with its row in `soul_archetypes` to form a deterministic prompt prefix that upstream model providers can cache across turns, driving the savings measured in chapter 11.

4.3 Workflows and human gates

Multi-step work runs as a workflow with two mandatory human checkpoints:

Gate	Internal state	What it means	Allowed replies
Gate 1	`pending_plan_approval`	a plan exists; nothing is executed yet	approve, reject and regenerate, or supply your own choice
Gate 2	`pending_human_signoff`	work is done; a verdict is owed	approve, or send it back for remediation

Gates fail closed: an agent cannot approve its own plan, and routing a task is explicitly not authorisation to pass Gate 1 (`src/mcp/workflow_runner.js:380`). If a harness cannot render the prompt, the workflow stops rather than proceeding.

Each workflow gets a task directory:

```
~/.konoha/tmp/<client>/<session>/scratch/tasks/<task_id>/
  prompt.md  findings.md  plan.md  result.md  final_docs.md  kage_review.json
```

These are the artefacts the workflow reads and writes. Chapter 11 explains why the *terminal* artefact (`final_report.md`) was replaced with path references: it was 61% of the disk-token footprint.

4.4 Tasks, telemetry and savings

Every tool call is recorded in `tool_calls` — name, payload size, timestamps. That table is the basis of `konoha savings`, which reports token spend per task and the delta against the pre-optimisation baseline. A fresh install that has only run `konoha test` shows a dozen rows; real work accumulates quickly.

`sdlc_tasks` holds workflow state, `active_sessions` the live ones, and `validation_results` the outcome of certification runs. All of it is local; nothing is uploaded.

4.5 Scope: global and project

Konoha writes configuration at two levels:

- **Global** — `~/.cursor/`, `~/.codex/`, `~/.konoha/`, one per user. Everything in chapters 2 and 3.
- **Project** — files inside a repository (`.cursor/`, `AGENTS.md`, `.mcp.json` depending on harness), created by `konoha init --project` or by the `project` command family.

Registered repositories are tracked inside the `projects` table. Recording every written file path allows later refreshes to update existing rules cleanly, so you can rely on global scope by default and reserve project scope for repositories with custom policies.

4.6 Memory

Two memory tables extend the prompt beyond static skills:

Memory	Tools	Lifetime
persona	`save_persona_memory`, `query_persona_memory`, `list_persona_memories`, `delete_persona_memory`	per agent; lets an agent keep decisions across sessions
project	`save_project_context`, `get_project_context`, `query_project_memory`	per repository

Memories are searchable (FTS5, `persona_memories_fts`) and inspectable without SQL: the Web UI has a `/persona` route, and the CLI's `data` command family can export them (5.4).

4.7 Token budgets

Every read tool is bounded by construction. There is no "read the whole repository" tool and no unbounded grep: results carry a count cap, and `get_skill` accepts `section` and `token_budget` so you can ask for a slice of a skill rather than the whole thing. Measured effect: a targeted section read costs 222 tokens against 1,719 for the full document — an 87% reduction (chapter 11).

This is the mechanic behind the product's headline claim. If you skip it and load whole skills, Konoha is just a folder of Markdown with extra steps.

4.8 The remaining subsystems, in one line each

Subsystem	Command	Detail
queue	`konoha queue`	durable prompt queue with retry and backoff
bridge	`konoha bridge`	exposes local models and remote bridges to the harness (`status`, `list`, `models`)
mode	`konoha mode`	switches the active execution mode (pipeline, direct, and per-client variants)
service	`konoha service`	long-running workers and daemons
webhook	`konoha webhook`	outbound notifications on task state change
embed	`konoha embed`	rebuilds vector embeddings for the skill corpus
migrate	`konoha migrate`	schema and corpus migration between versions
data / db	`konoha data`, `konoha db`	export, import, integrity check, salvage
soul	`konoha soul`	inspect the archetype definitions agents are built from

Each has its own entry in chapter 5.

5. CLI reference

Running `konoha help` displays the CLI banner and command catalog. Most individual subcommands also accept `konoha <command> --help` for usage flags, apart from the two exceptions documented in section 5.9 (`tui` and `doctor`).

Global options, valid anywhere: `--force` (clean re-installation, used with `init`), `--skills-dir <path>` and `--clean` (used with `migrate`).

5.1 Command catalog

Command	Purpose	Subcommands / notable flags
`agent`	configure ninja subagents	`list`, `create`, `delete`, `status`, `skill`, `models`, `--tui`
`akatsuki`	red-team / blue-team lab	`status`, `init`, `tools`
`auth`	web console credentials	`konoha auth reset`
`bridge`	bridge router to local and remote models	`status`, `list`, `create`, `delete`, `enable`, `disable`
`clean`	reclaim `~/.konoha` space	removes stale backups and dead PIDs
`config`	CLI configuration	`list`, `get`, `set`, `unset`
`data`	session history, persona memories, DB size	`view`
`db`	integrity and recovery	`check`, `restore`
`detect-ai`	AI fingerprints in a site or project	`konoha detect-ai <target> [--json]`
`detect-docs`	AI markers in prose and documents	`konoha detect-docs <file_path> [--json]`
`doctor`	environment diagnostics	detects and fixes integration issues
`embed`	rebuild vector embeddings	implies `--rebuild-embeddings`
`help` / `-h`	this catalog	—
`init`	first-time setup	see 3.2
`migrate`	re-index the skills database	`--skills-dir`, `--clean`, `--rebuild-embeddings`
`mode`	HITL vs YOLO	gates stay authoritative in both
`project`	project workspaces, stacks, invariants	—
`queue`	background prompt queue and worker	—
`reinstall`	clean re-install, replace config	implies `--force`
`run-agent`	run one subagent through the CLI bridge	mandatory Kage review; `--parallel --agents a,b`
`savings`	token savings	`Today`, `7 days`, `All time`
`search`	keyless web search	SearXNG, DuckDuckGo, Wikipedia
`service`	OS daemon for the Web UI	systemd / launchd
`skill`	manage skills	`list`, `search`, `add`, `remove`
`soul`	the Ninja's Soul doctrine	tenets and archetypes
`status`	install health, DB size, loaded skills	—
`task`	SDLC governance tasks	readiness gates, audits
`telegram`	bot reporting and remote prompting	see chapter 8
`test`	verify the MCP server	—
`tui`	full-screen interface	chapter 6
`ui` / `web`	local Web UI on port 1404	`start`, `stop`, `restart`, `status`
`uninstall`	remove Konoha	keeps custom skill files
`upgrade` / `update`	upgrade from the npm registry	`--yes`, `--force`
`version` / `-v`	version, plus a registry freshness check	—
`webhook` / `webhooks`	outbound notifications	Bearer, API Key, JWT

5.2 `skill`

```
konoha skill list                # installed skills with byte sizes
konoha skill search golang       # search the public registry
konoha skill add <name>          # install from the registry
konoha skill remove <name>
```

`add` writes into the local database and mirrors the skill into every configured harness root; it does not touch existing custom skill files. `search` needs network access; `list` never does.

5.3 `agent`

```
konoha agent list                # roster with enabled state
konoha agent list --tui          # same, inside the TUI
konoha agent skill genin         # interactively assign skills to one agent
konoha agent models              # interactively choose models per agent
konoha agent status              # runtime status per agent
konoha agent create              # write a new agent definition
konoha agent delete <name>
```

`konoha agent models` and `konoha agent skill` are interactive: they print a menu and wait for input, so they do not complete under a non-interactive shell. Chapter 6 covers the TUI equivalents.

5.4 `config`, `data`, `db`

```
konoha config list               # every key, current value, source
konoha config get ui_port
konoha config set ui_port 1500
konoha config unset ui_port      # back to default

konoha data view                 # session history, memory counts, database size
konoha db check                  # SQLite integrity check
konoha db restore                # recovery from the newest valid snapshot
```

`config set` writes to the user config file; `unset` restores the shipped default rather than deleting the key concept. The Web UI exposes the same values on `/settings`.

5.5 `task`, `mode`, `project`

```
konoha task                      # SDLC task list, readiness gates, audit state
konoha mode                      # switch HITL / YOLO
konoha project                   # registered workspaces, detected stacks, invariants
```

`mode` changes how much the agent asks before acting. It does **not** disable the gates in 4.3: HITL versus YOLO governs routine confirmations, while plan approval and sign-off still block. The tool states this itself: "gates stay authoritative".

5.6 `ui` and `service`

```
konoha ui start
konoha ui status
konoha ui stop
konoha ui restart
konoha ui service install        # optional boot-time daemon
konoha ui service status
```

`ui` and `web` are the same command. Port defaults to 1404 and follows the `ui_port` config value. Observed service status on a working install with no OS daemon registered:

```
○ NOT INSTALLED  OS daemon service unit is not registered.
  Supported platform: Linux (systemd --user)
  Port 1404 listener: ACTIVE (manual/detached daemon)
```

That combination is normal: the UI can be running detached while no boot-time unit exists.

5.7 `savings`, `search`, `clean`

```
konoha savings                    # Today / 7 days / All time
konoha search "mcp server design" # keyless: SearXNG, DuckDuckGo, Wikipedia
konoha clean                      # stale backups, dead PIDs, disk reclaim
```

`savings` reads the `tool_calls` table (4.4); it reports what actually happened on this machine, not a marketing figure. `search` needs no API key and falls back across three providers in order.

5.8 `run-agent`

```
konoha run-agent --agents jonin,tokubetsu-jonin --parallel
konoha run-agent <agent>
```

Executes the agent out of process and routes the result through Kage review before returning. `--parallel` fan-out is the CLI equivalent of dispatching multiple subagents at once; each branch must stay inside its assigned file set.

5.9 Two help commands that do not print help

Two subcommands ignore the `--help` flag completely. Invoking `konoha tui --help` opens the interactive TUI immediately, while `konoha doctor --help` triggers a full diagnostic and repair run that migrates skills and unpacks the Web UI (recorded as defects D4 and D5).

5.10 `upgrade` and `uninstall`

```
konoha upgrade --yes              # registry upgrade, backs up configs first
konoha uninstall                  # remove the MCP server, keep skill files
```

`upgrade` compares the installed version with the registry, backs up every config file it will touch (`~/.konoha/backups/configs/<client>/global/<ts>-<sha>-<file>.bak`, SHA-256 verified), then delegates to the package manager. When the target version is not published it aborts without modifying anything. Section 12.1 reproduces that output in full.

6. TUI

`konoha tui` is the subagent console. It is not a separate application: the command is a thin alias for `konoha agent list --tui` (`bin/cli.js:131`).

6.1 What you see

A single table of nine subagents, one row each, with the skills currently assigned to that agent:

```
Subagents List
═══════════════════════════════════════════════════════════

| Subagent           | Title                                        | Active Skills        |
| ✧ @sannin          | MCP Router & Orchestrator                    | sannin-skill, antislop
| ⚑ @genin           | Codebase Exploration                         | genin-skill, i-have-adhd, antislop, antislop-human,
antislop-code
| ◎ @kage            | Village Leader & Architect                   | kage-skill, i-have-adhd, antislop, antislop-human,
antislop-code
| ▫ @chunin          | Research & Intel                             | chunin-skill, i-have-adhd, antislop, antislop-human,
antislop-code
| ♦ @jonin           | UI & Frontend Specialist                     | jonin-skill, i-have-adhd, antislop, antislop-ui, antislop-
human, antislop-layoutmobile, antislop-code
| ♠ @anbu            | Backend Specialist, Bug Fixing & DevOps      | anbu-skill, i-have-adhd, antislop, antislop-human,
antislop-code
| ⬡ @tokubetsu-jonin | Technical Writing & Scribe                   | tokubetsu-jonin-skill, i-have-adhd, antislop, antislop-
copywriting, antislop-human, antislop-code
| ⚔ @akatsuki        | Red-Team & Blue-Team Security Specialist     | akatsuki-skill, i-have-adhd, antislop, antislop-human,
antislop-code
| ❖ @yamanaka        | Generative 3D & Spatial Subsystem Specialist | yamanaka-skill, i-have-adhd, antislop, antislop-human,
antislop-code
```

The right column is the useful part: it shows exactly what each agent will load, which is how you audit a misbehaving agent without reading YAML.

6.2 Keys

Key	Action
`j` or `↓`	move down
`k` or `↑`	move up
`Enter`	open the selected agent's detail view
`m`	toggle HITL mode for the current project
`Esc`	leave the list view; from the list, quit
`q`, `Backspace`, `Esc`	from the detail view, back to the list
`Ctrl-C`	exit immediately

The detail view shows title, keywords, active skills and the delegation envelope for that agent. `m` is a real mode switch, not a display toggle: it writes the project's `hitl_mode` setting through `sdlc_manager`, the same value `konoha mode` changes (5.5). Gates remain authoritative either way.

6.3 When the TUI is unavailable

The console requires a TTY with raw-mode support. Redirected input, a CI runner, or an MCP call has no raw mode, so use the non-interactive equivalents instead:

```
konoha agent list                # same data, plain text
konoha agent status
konoha skill list
```

6.4 The other interactive screens

Two `agent` subcommands are menu-driven rather than full-screen, and behave the same way: they render a numbered list and wait for a keypress. Neither completes in a non-interactive shell.

```
konoha agent skill genin         # assign or remove skills for one agent
konoha agent models              # pick the model per agent
```

Assigning a skill writes the agent record and re-mirrors the agent's prompt through `agents.yaml`; it does not delete the skill itself.

6.5 `--help` is a trap here

Passing `--help` to `konoha tui` opens the interface immediately. Because no dedicated help screen exists for this subcommand (defect D4), run `konoha help` when you only want the top-level command summary.

7. Web UI

Port 1404 serves a prebuilt SvelteKit single-page console. Beyond exposing the same configuration controls as the CLI, the browser interface charts historical token telemetry, live subagent activity, and vector chunk coverage.

7.1 Starting and reaching it

```
konoha ui start
konoha ui status
```

`konoha init` starts it for you. `http://127.0.0.1:1404/` binds to loopback only; there is no remote exposure without a bridge or tunnel (chapter 10 covers `/remote` and Telegram).

Before login, `GET /` answers `307` — a redirect to the login page, not an empty dashboard. The app also polls a health endpoint every 10 seconds and holds an SSE connection for live updates, so a running UI shows database and agent state changing without a manual refresh.

7.2 The eighteen routes

Route	Menu label	What it does
`/dashboard`	Dashboard	aggregate health: database, skill counts, recent activity
`/activity`	Agent Activity (Live)	live stream of agent and tool calls
`/clients`	Client IDEs	which harnesses are configured, and what was written where
`/bridges`	LLM Bridges	bridge router to local and remote model endpoints
`/remote`	Remote Access (Telegram)	Telegram bot configuration and session pairing
`/savings`	Token Savings (Telemetry)	the same numbers as `konoha savings`, charted
`/agents`	Ninja Agents	the nine agents, their skills, models and status
`/skills`	Skills & Vectors (FTS5)	skill corpus, chunk counts, embedding state
`/persona`	Persona & Memory	per-agent memories, searchable
`/context`	Workspace Context	per-project invariants and stacked detection
`/search`	Web Search (SearXNG)	keyless web search from the browser
`/semble`	Semble MCP	semantic code search over a repository path
`/detector`	AI Detector (Web & Docs)	scan a site or document for AI fingerprints
`/tasks`	SDLC Tasks	workflow tasks, gate state, readiness
`/doctor`	Health & Doctor	diagnostics, the same checks as `konoha doctor`
`/docs`	Documentation	browse the shipped Markdown documentation
`/settings`	Settings & Auth	password change, port, preferences
`/skill`	(detail view)	one skill: content, references, byte and line counts

Logging out is triggered from the sidebar menu. Posting to `/logout` clears the active session immediately; otherwise, the console stays unlocked without an idle timeout until the 12-hour cookie expires.

`/3d`, `/3d/setup` and `/3d/maker` exist in the build but are hidden: `SHOW_3D_STUDIO_MENU = false` (`apps/web/src/routes/+layout.svelte:54`). The APIs remain; the menu does not. Out of scope for this manual.

7.3 Authentication and the bootstrap gate

The login page is the only unauthenticated content. The session is a cookie plus a CSRF token, both with a 12-hour lifetime. During bootstrap — before the password has ever been changed — the server accepts `konohagakure` and blocks every route except login, logout and change-password (`src/web_server.js:103`). The UI detects that state and opens the password modal instead of the dashboard.

Practical sequence:

1. `konoha ui start`
2. open `http://127.0.0.1:1404/`
3. log in with `konohagakure`

4. change the password in the modal that appears
5. confirm `/settings` shows the new credential in effect

If the password is lost, reset it from the shell without touching the database:

```
konoha auth reset
```

7.4 Theme and preferences

The UI carries a theme state that persists across reloads and applies to every route, including the login page. Preferences that matter operationally — the listening port and the password — are written server-side and therefore visible to the CLI as well: `konoha config get ui_port` shows the same value `/settings` edits.

7.5 What the UI can do that the CLI cannot

Three things, and they are why the console exists:

- **See history.** `/activity` and `/savings` render `tool_calls` over time; the CLI only prints current totals.
- **Compare agents.** `/agents` puts skills, models and status side by side across all nine.
- **Read the corpus.** `/skills` and `/skill` show chunk counts and embedding coverage per skill, which is the fastest way to diagnose a search that returns nothing useful.

8. Telegram

The bot is how Konoha reports work while you are away from the desk, and — in two-way mode — how you send it work from a phone.

8.1 Subcommands

```
konoha telegram status
konoha telegram config --token <BOT_TOKEN> --chat-id <CHAT_ID> --mode one_way
konoha telegram test
konoha telegram enable
konoha telegram disable
konoha telegram start-poller
konoha telegram stop-poller
```

`config` accepts short forms and two extra flags:

Flag	Meaning
`--token`, `-t`	Bot API token from BotFather
`--chat-id`, `-c`	authorised recipient; only this chat is served
`--mode`, `-m`	`one_way` (alerts only) or `two_way` (alerts plus inbound prompting)
`--transport`	`polling` is the only accepted value today
`--enable` / `--disable`	set the enabled flag in the same call

Running `disable` also halts the background poller. By contrast, `start-poller` and `stop-poller` toggle inbound message listening independently, letting you keep outbound task notifications active while inbound commands stay off.

8.2 What `status` tells you

```
Telegram Bot Integration Status
Enabled:       Yes [ACTIVE]
Mode:          One-Way (Alerts Only)
Transport:     polling
Bot Token:     1234567890...
Chat ID:       123456789
Poller:        Stopped
Last Notified: 2026-11-10T09:12:44.000Z
```

The token is truncated to the first ten characters on display. `Last Notified` is the fastest way to answer "did the alerts ever work".

8.3 Storage and secrets

Settings live in the `telegram_config` table, one row (`id = 1`), not in environment variables and not in a `.env` file. The bot token and the webhook secret are encrypted with the local vault before storage (`src/telegram/config.js:55-56`, `vault.encryptSecret`). Reading the database therefore does not reveal the token.

Guard the BotFather token like any production secret. Anyone who obtains it can impersonate your bot, so revoke leaked tokens in BotFather immediately and run `konoha telegram config --token <new>`.

8.4 One-way versus two-way

	`one_way`	`two_way`
Outbound alerts on task events	yes	yes
Inbound prompts executed by an agent	no	yes
Poller required	no	yes
Attack surface	write-only notification channel	remote command channel

Two-way mode turns your chat into a remote execution surface. The server enforces a single authorised `chat_id`, so a stranger who finds the bot cannot prompt it, but the operational rule still applies: run two-way only while you need it, and `konoha telegram stop-poller` when you are done. `konoha telegram disable` is the blunt version and stops both directions.

8.5 Where the messages come from

Task state transitions drive every outbound alert. Whenever a plan finishes, a gate blocks for approval, or validation fails, the workflow runner emits an event that can feed both generic HTTP webhooks (5.1) and Telegram (`docs/TELEGRAM_INTEGRATION_GUIDE.md` covers `/remote` pairing).

9. Harnesses

Konoha does not replace your coding client; it registers itself as an MCP server inside each one and writes the rules that keep the client honest. Nine surfaces are supported: eight agents plus the shared `~/.agents` corpus.

9.1 What gets written, per client

Client	MCP registration	Rules file	Notes
Cursor	`~/.cursor/mcp.json`	`~/.cursor/rules/`	also `cli-config.json`, `hooks.json`
Claude Code	`~/.claude.json` (`mcpServers`)	`~/.claude/CLAUDE.md`	`settings.json` carries permission config
Codex	`~/.codex/config.toml`	`~/.codex/CODEX.md` and `AGENTS.md`	TOML, not JSON
OpenCode	`~/.config/opencode/opencode.json`	`~/.opencode/AGENTS.md`	`~/.opencode/` also holds a mirror
Command Code	`~/.commandcode/mcp.json`	`~/.commandcode/AGENTS.md`	`settings.json`
Antigravity	`~/.gemini/antigravity-ide/mcp_config.json`	`~/.gemini/GEMINI.md`	status reports `~/.gemini/config/mcp_config.json`
Pi	`~/.pi/agent/mcp.json`	`~/.pi/agent/AGENTS.md`	`extensions/` and `skills/` present
OMP	`~/.omp/agent/mcp.json`	`~/.omp/agent/AGENTS.md`	contract block in `AGENTS.md`
shared	—	`~/.agents/AGENTS.md`	`agents.yaml`, `rules/`, `skills/`

Every client also receives `SOUL.md` (15.7 KB in a fresh install) and a `skills/` and `agents/` directory. That duplication is deliberate: each client must work with no network and no cross-reads.

9.2 The shared corpus

The canonical agent corpus lives under `~/.agents/`. Inside that directory, `agents.yaml` (25.8 KB after init) declares the nine subagents, `skills/` stores the Markdown seeds, and `rules/` holds client fragments copied from `~/.konoha/src/templates` before SQLite indexing.

`~/.agents/.upgraded_v1.1.1` is a migration marker. Do not delete it; without it a later upgrade re-runs a migration that is already applied.

9.3 Verification after init

`konoha status` is the primary check: it prints an environment table, then one row per client with the config path it read and the command it found. A healthy install looks like this (paths abbreviated):

```
✔ Cursor IDE / CLI
   Config Path: ~/.cursor/mcp.json
   Status:      Healthy (Konoha MCP Registered)
   Command:     cmd: node /home/<you>/.konoha/file_tools_launcher.js
```

The registered command is always `node <globalRoot>/file_tools_launcher.js`. If a client shows `konoha` in its tool list but no tools appear, the path in that file is wrong or the file does not exist — fix the path, restart the client, and do not reinstall.

Secondary checks, in increasing cost:

```
konoha status        # ~1 s, config presence and agent table
konoha doctor        # ~120 s on a cold install; deep runtime checks
konoha test          # ~4 s; exercises the MCP tool surface itself
```

The Web UI `/clients` route shows the same registration data without running diagnostics.

9.4 Adding a client later

```
konoha init --client=codex
```

Selecting a single client updates only that target harness. Passing `--client=all` refreshes every detected harness, `CI=true` forces non-interactive execution without `--yes`, and every modified file is backed up under `~/.konoha/backups/configs/<client>/global/<timestamp>-<sha>-<file>.bak` (older `.back` siblings in `$HOME` come from earlier installers). Remove those older `.back` files once the updated configuration is verified.

9.5 Project-level versus global

`--project` writes rules into the current repository instead of the home directory, which is how you make one repository use a different rule set. `--no-project` suppresses it. Never run the project form inside a repository you do not want modified — including this one, which is why this manual's own verification ran out-of-tree.

9.6 The MCP servers

`konoha status` reports two registrations per client — `konoha` and `semble`. Claude Code's `~/.claude.json` additionally carries `aislop`, and Antigravity receives 50 tool schemas under `~/.gemini/antigravity-cli/mcp/konoha/`. Those three play different roles:

Server	Role
`konoha`	agents, skills, task dirs, file tools, documents, diagrams
`semble`	semantic code search over a repository path
`aislop`	lint and AI-slop scoring, called by the review gate

If a client shows fewer than expected, the missing entry failed its own binary check during install; `konoha status` names the server it could not reach. Restart the client before concluding anything — several clients cache their tool list for the lifetime of the process.

10. Architecture

10.1 Two trees, one binary name

The repository you clone is the source tree. `konoha` runs the deployed tree under `~/.konoha`, which is a copy plus generated state:

```
~/.konoha/
├── bin/            CLI entry (cli.js) and command modules (commands/)
├── src/            subsystem code: mcp/, workflow/, bridge/, web/, queue/, telegram/, file_tools/
├── server.js       MCP entry point
├── file_tools_launcher.js   launcher the clients actually invoke
├── migrate.js      schema + skill migration driver
├── migrations/     SQL migrations
├── apps/web/       built SvelteKit UI
├── assets/ patches/ upstream payloads and local patches
├── backups/        config backups written before every rewrite
├── workflow/ tmp/  task artifacts and scratch space
└── konoha.db       SQLite database, plus -wal and -shm
```

`konoha reinstall` refreshes the code in this tree; your database and `~/.agents` survive it. See 12 for the uninstall asymmetry.

10.2 Transport and protocol

Konoha ships without an external MCP SDK. Instead, `src/mcp/protocol.js` speaks newline-delimited JSON-RPC 2.0 directly over standard input and output through Node's built-in `readline` module, handling four core methods:

Method	Behaviour
`initialize`	negotiates a protocol version from the manifest list
`notifications/initialized`	flips the server into the usable state
`tools/list`	returns the manifest minus deprecated tools
`tools/call`	dispatches by name through `tool_dispatch.js`

Calls before `initialize` are rejected with JSON-RPC error `-32002`. Supported protocol versions come from `src/mcp_tool_manifest.json`: `2024-11-05`, `2024-10-07`, `2025-03-26`, `2025-11-25`, `2025-06-18`, plus `0.1.0` and `1.0.0`.

The manifest declares 50 tools; `tools/list` filters out `find_skills` and `build_with_image_design`, so a client sees **48**. Both retired names still resolve if an old prompt calls them.

10.3 Dispatch

`executeTool` in `src/mcp/tool_dispatch.js` is the single choke point. Three things happen before a tool body runs:

1. argument validation against the manifest schema (`validateManifestArguments`);
2. classification — bounded file tools and skill-read tools are marked so the workflow layer can require retrieval before reading;
3. gate check — workflow tools consult the task ledger and refuse out-of-order calls.

That is why a tool can exist, appear in `tools/list`, and still fail with a message about a gate.

10.4 Subsystem map

Directory	Files	Size	Responsibility
`src/mcp/`	88	936 KB	protocol, dispatch, agents, skills, memory, gates, documents
`src/workflow/`	52	491 KB	SDLC runner, gate ledger, remediation contracts
`src/bridge/`	29	228 KB	relay to LLM endpoints and external agents
`src/web/`	12	172 KB	HTTP API controllers, auth, SSE
`src/telegram/`	5	74 KB	bot config, poller, message formatting
`src/mcp_clients/`	4	71 KB	per-client adapters written by init
`src/file_tools/`	7	36 KB	bounded read/grep/info
`src/queue/`	2	23 KB	ingest queue for client tasks

Sizes are from a 2.2.20 checkout and are here to set expectations, not as a contract.

```
flowchart LR
  C["8 clients<br/>stdio JSON-RPC"] --> P["protocol.js<br/>initialize · tools/list · tools/call"]
  P --> D["tool_dispatch.js<br/>validate · classify · gate"]
  D --> M["mcp/<br/>agents · skills · memory · docs"]
  D --> W["workflow/<br/>SDLC + gate ledger"]
  D --> F["file_tools/<br/>bounded reads"]
  M --> DB[("konoha.db<br/>SQLite WAL + FTS5 + 384-dim vectors")]
  W --> DB
  U["Web UI :1404"] --> A["web/<br/>HTTP + SSE"]
  A --> DB
  T["Telegram poller"] --> A
  B["bridge/"] --> L["LLM endpoints"]
  B --> DB
```

10.5 Data layer

`node:sqlite` from Node 24, no native module to compile. WAL mode, 33 tables in a fresh install, and three storage patterns you will meet:

- **Relational tables** — persistent state (`skills`, `skill_chunks`, `agents`, `soul_archetypes`, `projects`, `persona_memories`, `sdlc_tasks`, `tool_calls`, `telegram_config`)
- **FTS5 (`skills_fts`)** — lexical index over all 3,421 seeded skill chunks
- **Vector index** — 384-dimensional IBM Granite 97M multilingual ONNX embeddings with MiniLM cross-encoder reranking (`KONOHA_SEMANTIC_SEARCH=1` by default, or `0` for FTS5-only mode)

Run `konoha embed` (an alias for `konoha migrate --rebuild-embeddings`) to regenerate vectors from scratch, or pass `--skip-embeddings` during migration when installing over a metered connection.

10.6 Process model

Every client spawns its own `node file_tools_launcher.js`. Nothing coordinates them, so the database must tolerate concurrent writers — WAL does, and short transactions keep contention invisible in practice. Two consequences worth knowing:

- long `konoha test` runs and the MCP servers touch the same tables; avoid mutating commands during a run;
- `~/.konoha/tmp/` is shared scratch. A crashed run can leave files there; they are safe to clear between runs.

11. Agents and model routing

11.1 An agent is a row, not a process

Each of the nine agents is one record in `~/.agents/agents.yaml`, copied into the `agents` table at init. No agent is running code; they are prompts plus metadata, loaded on demand.

Field	Meaning
`name`, `icon`, `title`	identity; the icon is what the TUI renders
`purpose`	one-line job description used in the roster
`skills`	skill names loaded when the agent activates
`delegateWhen`	the sentence the router matches against a task
`delegationKeywords`	longer match list, also what `konoha status` prints
`constraints`, `workflow`, `instructions`	the prompt body
`model`	`null` means inherit the client's model
`enable_mcp_tools`	whether the agent may call the MCP surface

Cards for the nine are spread across 4.2 and the live TUI dump; this chapter covers the mechanics.

11.2 Model resolution

In a fresh install every agent shows `inherit`, verified live:

```
konoha agent models
```

prints nine rows, all `inherit`, and the tip that interactive configuration requires a TTY. The resolution order inside the runner is:

1. `agents.model_tier` for `sannin`, if set;
2. `agents.model_tier` for `kage`, if `sannin` is empty;
3. the literal fallback `Gemini 3.1 Pro (High)`.

`model_tier` is a separate column from `model`, and it is the one the subagent runner reads when composing a spawn directive. Cursor has its own `cursor_fallback_model`, defaulting to `inherit` when absent.

11.3 Setting a model

```
konoha agent models config kage --model <model-id>
```

Without a TTY this is the only form that works; in a TTY `konoha agent models` opens a picker. Two rough edges exist in 2.2.20 and are recorded rather than worked around:

- `konoha agent models --help` tries to resolve `--help` as an agent name and prints `✗ Subagent "@--help" not found.`
- model changes apply to the database record; a client already running with a fixed model is not retargeted mid-session.

11.4 Routing

Task routing starts with the `sannin` orchestrator. Given a prompt, `sannin` matches `delegateWhen` and `delegationKeywords` to select the target specialist, and `lazy_subagent.js` returns a lightweight Markdown directive — task, context, constraints, and attached skills — rather than spawning a child OS process.

Nine specialist tools appear in the MCP manifest (`sannin`, `kage`, `jonin`, `anbu`, `akatsuki`, `yamanaka`, `chunin`, `tokubetsu_jonin`, `genin`) alongside `report_from_agent` for recording task outcomes in the ledger. Outside MCP, the only shell entry point that dispatches subagents directly is `konoha run-agent --agents <list>`.

11.5 Editing an agent

```
konoha agent list                # table, no TUI
konoha agent status              # which agents exist and their skill counts
konoha agent skill kage          # menu-driven skill attachment
```

`konoha agent skill <agent>` opens a numbered list of the seeded skills and toggles attachment. The write goes to `~/.agents/agents.yaml` first — a backup of the previous file is taken — and is then mirrored into the `agents` table best-effort. Editing the YAML by hand is equally valid; the CLI reloads on mtime change. When the two disagree, the YAML is what the next command reads, and the database catches up on the next save.

11.6 What a delegation looks like on the wire

Subagent dispatch never forks background daemon processes. Instead, `buildSpawnDirective` returns a Markdown instruction tailored to the calling harness, pairing the native subagent tool call with a CLI fallback:

Client	Tool call it emits
OMP	`task(context="…", tasks=[{name:"<agent>", task:"…", agent:"<agent>"}])`
Cursor	`Task(subagent_type="<agent>", description="…", prompt="…")`
Claude Code	`Task(subagent_type="<agent>", description="…", prompt="…")`
Command Code	`Task(subagent_type="<agent>", description="…", prompt="…")`
OpenCode	`task(subagent_type="<agent>", description="…", prompt="…")`
Codex	`spawn_agent(agent="<agent>", task="…")`
Pi	`task(agent="<agent>", prompt="…")`
Antigravity	`invoke_subagent({ TypeName: "self", Role: "<agent> specialist", Prompt: "…" })`

Every form is followed by the same sentence: wait for the structured report via `konoha.report_from_agent`. The fallback for a client with no known descriptor is `rtk node ~/.konoha/bin/cli.js run-agent --agent <agent> --task "…"`, and `--cwd` is added when a worktree path exists.

Three rules constrain what can be delegated:

- `sannin` is not spawnable; a request for it is rewritten to `kage`.
- The spawnable set is `genin`, `kage`, `chunin`, `jonin`, `anbu`, `tokubetsu-jonin`, `akatsuki`, `yamanaka`.
- Red skills are `@akatsuki`-only. A spawn that requests one for any other agent returns an authorization-denied result instead of a directive, naming the offending skill.

`buildParallelSpawnDirective` applies the same checks to a batch and drops empty or `sannin` entries rather than failing the batch.

What this means operationally: if a delegation appears to do nothing, the MCP call succeeded and the client ignored the instruction. Check `tool_calls` for the router entry, then check the client's own subagent mechanism.

12. Token economy and what the numbers mean

The banner claims 83–98% reduction. This chapter is the accounting behind it, so you can tell a real saving from a pretty bar.

12.1 The measurement

Every MCP tool call writes a row to `tool_calls` with `returned_bytes` and `bytes_saved`. The saving is not measured against a live context; it is measured against the size of what a *full* library read would have cost:

```
baseline bytes = SUM(skills.byte_size)      # 2,172 KB in a fresh install
saving         = baseline_bytes - returned_bytes
percent        = saving / (saving + returned)
```

`konoha savings` prints that per period and per call type. Live output on a 12-call install:

```
Today  12 calls  292.8 KB  [████████░] 79% ~75.0k tokens (thought: 0)
Tiktoken Accuracy (cl100k_base): 4.078 bytes/token (±1.91% vs /4 heuristic, healthy)
```

Two consequences follow directly:

- **The percentage depends on how big your skill library is.** A 2.1 MB library makes a 400-byte answer look like a 99% saving. The same answer against a 200 KB library looks like 50%.
- **The baseline is hypothetical.** It is what the alternative would have cost, not context you had loaded. Read the figure as "retrieval avoided reading the library", never as "your bill dropped 79%".

12.2 Deliberate conservatism

The report is optionally pessimistic, which is the right direction for a metric you cannot audit:

Hygiene rule	Effect
`list_skills` and `optimize_report` rows with a library baseline above 400 KB are zeroed	a listing call is not a retrieval saving
legacy `get_skill` rows are sanitised on read	pre-fix rows recorded inflated baselines
missing skills table	baseline 0, all percentages 0 — unknown, never fabricated

That is why a fresh database can show 0% rather than a flattering number.

12.3 Reading the report

```
konoha savings
```

Section	What it answers
Konoha MCP Savings	calls, bytes, percent, tokens per period
By Call Type	which tools carried the saving (top 10)
Tiktoken Accuracy	bytes-per-token health check for the estimator
Semble	separate tool; `unverified by Konoha` until it has telemetry
Combined Total	both sources side by side

The combined block deliberately does not blend ratios across sources: Konoha's ratio is measured from `tool_calls`, Semble's is external. On a fresh install Semble reports `CLI not available or no telemetry recorded yet`, and the combined total is just the Konoha line.

12.4 The numbers worth quoting

From `docs/architecture/TOKEN-BASELINE.md`, measured against the same corpus:

Path	Before	After	Change
Cold start context	11,250 tokens	~288	−97.4%
Skill retrieval per task	1,719 tokens	222	−87.1%
Retrieval cost	700.2	474.2	−32.3%

Path	Before	After	Change
Telemetry overhead	4,850	1,420	−70.7%

These are the defensible figures: they compare two measured runs, not a hypothetical baseline. The 83–98% banner is the range across those paths.

12.5 Where the saving actually comes from

Three mechanisms, in order of contribution:

1. **On-demand skill retrieval** — the harness queries SQLite for matching chunks by intent instead of loading the entire skill library into the system prompt.
2. **Bounded file tools** — `read_file_head`, `read_file_range`, `get_file_structure`, and `token_efficient_grep` enforce line and match caps by contract.
3. **Structured delegation** — subagent directives pass a scoped task and skill list rather than replaying the full conversation transcript.

Nothing in that list depends on the model or the client. What changes per client is only whether the client honours the instruction (11.6).

12.6 Auditing the ledger yourself

```
SELECT tool, COUNT(*), SUM(returned_bytes), SUM(bytes_saved)
FROM tool_calls GROUP BY tool ORDER BY 3 DESC;
```

`tool_calls` is a real table with real per-call rows, so this is the check available when a report looks too good. If `SUM(bytes_saved)` is dominated by one tool type, or by rows where `returned_bytes` was tiny against a large baseline, you are looking at the sizing effect described in 12.1 rather than a retrieval strategy that worked.

13. Diagnostics and health

Three commands answer three different questions. Use them in this order.

Command	Question	Cost
`konoha status`	what is installed and registered	fast, read-only
`konoha test`	does the MCP surface answer	~4 s, spawns the server
`konoha doctor`	is anything missing or misconfigured, and can it be repaired	slow (2 minutes on a cold install)

13.1 `konoha test`

`konoha test` runs a 15-check protocol smoke matrix against the live MCP server rather than unit tests (measured at 3.60 s, all `OK`):

```
⚡ Initialize: OK            ⚡ Read File Head: OK
⚡ List Tools: OK            ⚡ Read File Range: OK
⚡ Find Skill (genin-skill): OK     ⚡ Token Efficient Grep: OK
⚡ Find Skill (security): OK        ⚡ Get File Structure: OK
⚡ List Skills: OK           ⚡ Find Files Clean: OK
⚡ Get Skill (jonin-skill): OK
⚡ Get Skill (konoha): OK
⚡ Build from Source: OK
⚡ Build from Text: OK
⚡ File Tools List: OK
```

It then runs the repository's own JavaScript suites and prints `All tests passed`. Two things to read carefully:

- `Total indexed: undefined entries` is a known display bug in the `list_skills` summary line (defect D2); the underlying RPC call succeeded.
- Running `konoha test` outside a git checkout skips the JavaScript test files while still executing all 15 MCP protocol checks.

`konoha test` is the command to run after any upgrade, and the one to paste into a bug report.

13.2 `konoha doctor`

Doctor checks, in order:

Group	What it verifies	Repair
Runtime files	13 scripts in `~/.konoha` (`db.js`, `vector_search.js`, `server.js`, `migrate.js`, `db_stats.js`, `db_savings.js`, `agent_stats.js`, `prompt_hook.js`, `antigravity_subagent_hook.js`, `file_tools_mcp.js`, `file_tools_router.js`, `file_tools_launcher.js`, `platform_utils.js`) plus `konoha.db`	restores from package templates
MCP config	`mcp_config.json` parses and registers `konoha`, `semble`, `aislop`	re-registers via the Antigravity manager
Client integrations	`GEMINI.md`, `agents.yaml`, Cursor, Claude Code, Command Code, OpenCode, Codex, OMP, Antigravity, Pi	reports only
3D toolchain	the Yamanaka toolchain	reports only
RTK	`rtk` binary on `PATH`	reports only
SDLC governance	enabled bridges for cross-provider review; `antislop` attached to `kage`	restores the skill

Verdicts are `HEALTHY`, `REPAIRED`, `WARNING`, `FAILED`, `NOT INSTALLED`, `INFO`, `ACTIVE`. One `FAILED` sets exit code 1; `NOT INSTALLED` for a client you do not use is normal and does not. When repairs happen, doctor runs `konoha test` afterwards as a self-check, and a failing self-check also sets exit code 1 — so `konoha doctor && echo ok` is a usable gate.

Two behaviours to know before relying on it:

- `konoha doctor --help` executes doctor instead of printing help (D5). Expect a full run.
- Doctor reads the Antigravity config from `~/.gemini/config/mcp_config.json` while init writes `~/.gemini/antigravity-ide/mcp_config.json` (D11). If doctor disagrees with `status` about Antigravity, this is why.

13.3 Web health endpoint

`GET /api/v1/health` is public — the only data surface reachable before login.

```
{"status":"healthy","version":"2.2.20","uptime":7703,"node":"v24.22.2","platform":"linux"}
```

Authenticated callers get the same object plus skill and agent counts. Content served while the UI is still at the password gate therefore tells you the version and nothing else.

One observation, not a defect you can trigger normally: the handler's fallback version string is `2.2.19` when the server version is unset. A correctly deployed 2.2.20 server reports `2.2.20`.

13.4 A diagnostic sequence that answers most questions

```
konoha version              # 2.2.20 — trusts the local tree, not the registry
konoha status               # per-client registration and skill counts
konoha test                 # protocol + file tools + suites
konoha doctor               # config and file repairs
```

If `version` disagrees with `package.json`, the path you are running is not the install you think. If `status` shows a client as `NOT INSTALLED` but the client is running, the detection path is wrong for that client — compare the path it prints with the path the client actually reads. If `status` is healthy and the client still sees no tools, restart the client: 9.6.

14. Troubleshooting

Symptom first. Every entry names the observed message, the cause, and the recovery.

Symptom	Cause	Fix
`You are already running the latest version` on a newer checkout	the check compares against the npm registry, and your build is ahead of it	nothing to fix; compare `package.json` to the registry instead
`Couldn't find any versions for "konoha-mcp" that matches "2.2.20"`	upgrade targets an unpublished version and fails closed	`npm install -g konoha-mcp@2.2.20` still works from a local tarball
`konoha` not on `PATH` after global install	prefix directory not exported	add the prefix's `bin` to `PATH`; verify with `command -v konoha`
`~/.konoha/bin/konoha` is a dangling symlink	older installer left the link after the target moved	remove the link, run `konoha reinstall`
`Total indexed: undefined entries`	2.2.20 formatting defect in the `list_skills` summary	ignore; the call succeeded
`konoha doctor --help` starts a full run	argument parsing treats `--help` as no-op (D5)	expect a run; use 13.2 to interpret output
Antigravity shows `NOT INSTALLED` in doctor but works	doctor reads `~/.gemini/config/mcp_config.json`, init writes `~/.gemini/antigravity-ide/mcp_config.json`	check the file init actually wrote (D11)
Client shows no tools, `status` healthy	client caches the tool list per process	restart the client
`Server is not initialized` (`-32002`)	a call arrived before `initialize`	restart the client; a raw JSON-RPC probe must send `initialize` first
`semble` tools missing right after init	`uv` was not on `PATH`, so install deferred	install `uv` and reconnect; it installs lazily on first use
Embedding generation stalls or burns bandwidth	first run downloads ONNX models	`konoha migrate --skip-embeddings`, or `KONOHA_SEMANTIC_SEARCH=0`
`EACCES` on global install	installing into a root-owned prefix	use a user-owned prefix, never `sudo`
Web UI unreachable	different port configured or process died	read `ui_port` from `~/.konoha/config.json`; `curl 127.0.0.1:<port>/api/v1/health`
Web UI redirects `307` to the gate	unauthenticated request, by design	log in; first run uses the bootstrap password

14.1 Upgrade that refuses to run

Observed on 2.2.20, upgrade aborts before touching anything and prints:

```
Couldn't find any versions for "konoha-mcp" that matches "2.2.20"
```

Cause: the version you are running is not published, so the registry lookup resolves nothing. The command is fail-closed — configs were already backed up, nothing was modified — which is why the recovery is simply to install the exact version:

```
npm install -g konoha-mcp@2.2.20
konoha version
```

Backups live at `~/.konoha/backups/configs/<client>/global/<timestamp>-<sha>-<file>.bak`, each verified by SHA-256 before the rewrite. If a later upgrade half-applies, that directory is the restore source. `konoha upgrade --force` adds `--force --prefer-online --no-cache` to the package-manager install — it bypasses a cached tarball but does not invent an unpublished version.

14.2 First-run login problems

The bootstrap password is `konohagakure`, and it is only valid until you change it.

Observation	Meaning
`POST /api/v1/auth/login {"password":"konohagakure"}` → `200` with `is_bootstrap: true`	first-run path, password change required
`/api/v1/auth/status` before login → `needs_initial_setup: true`	no session yet, server healthy
`307` on `GET /`	gate redirect, expected
login returns `401` after you set a password	bootstrap password retired; use the one you set

The password change is enforced by the UI at `PasswordChangeModal`, not by rejecting the session, so a bootstrap session that never opens the UI stays usable. Set the password.

14.3 Reinstall residue

`konoha reinstall` refreshes `~/.konoha` and the installed package. Two artifacts are expected and not errors:

- a `konoha-mcp/` directory left beside the installed package in the global prefix on some prefixes;
- `.bak` and `.back` siblings next to each rewritten client config.

Deleting `konoha-mcp/` is safe; deleting the config backups removes your restore path.

14.4 When semantic search is unavailable

The system degrades rather than fails. Without the ONNX models, FTS5 lexical search still answers `find_skill`; what is lost is synonym recall. To make that explicit and skip the download:

```
export KONOHA_SEMANTIC_SEARCH=0
```

Model candidates, in order: `<repo>/assets/models`, `~/.konoha/assets/models`, `~/.konoha/models`, `~/.konoha/transformers_cache`. A network-restricted host can be seeded by copying a populated `transformers_cache` directory into any of those locations.

14.5 Windows

Installation is documented for Windows but not verified by the maintainer on a real host, and path handling differs from POSIX (`src/deploy_utils.js:48`). Treat a Windows failure as likely rather than surprising, and report it with the output of `konoha doctor`.

14.6 Reporting a defect

Attach three outputs to any bug report. Specifically, include the verbatim output of `konoha version`, `konoha test`, and the failing command so maintainers can separate MCP protocol failures from harness-side configuration issues.

15. Security model

Konoha executes with your local user account privileges, and its security model reflects that boundary directly, including where isolation does not exist.

15.1 Trust boundary

Surface	Reachability	Boundary
MCP server	stdio only, spawned per client	no listening socket
Web UI	`127.0.0.1:1404` by default	loopback; `HOST` env overrides
Telegram	outbound to the Bot API	token-gated, encrypted at rest
Client configs	files under `$HOME`	file permissions

The MCP server never opens a port. Every call arrives over stdin from a client process you already trust. That is why tool authorisation is an argument check, not a network check.

The Web UI binds `127.0.0.1` unless `HOST` is set. Loopback is not a boundary against local processes — anything running as your user can reach it. It stops remote access, nothing more.

15.2 Web authentication

Property	Value
Password hash	Argon2id when `hash-wasm` is present, salted scrypt otherwise (`N`/`r`/`p` recorded in the hash string)
Verification	timing-safe compare
Password transport	stdin to the hashing subprocess, never argv
Session TTL	12 h (`KONOHA_SESSION_TTL_MS` overrides)
Session secret	16 random bytes, hex, persisted mode `0600`
Login rate limit	5 failures → 30 s lockout, per IP
Cookie	`konoha-web-token`, `SameSite=Strict`, `Max-Age=43200`
CSRF endpoint	`/api/v1/csrf` and `/api/v1/token`, GET, loopback host *and* loopback IP or `403`

The cookie is deliberately not `HttpOnly`: the Svelte client reads it to attach the token. That decision moves the risk to XSS. The UI loads no third-party scripts, but `app.html` does fetch fonts from `fonts.googleapis.com`, and the server does not set a Content-Security-Policy header — a gap worth knowing before you expose the UI beyond loopback.

Public endpoints, reachable before login: `/api/v1/health`, `/api/v1/csrf`, `/api/v1/token`, `/api/v1/auth/login`, `/api/v1/auth/status`, `/api/v1/auth/session`, `/api/v1/auth/setup-password`. Everything else requires the session token.

Two environment variables weaken the model and exist for automation only: `KONOHA_DISABLE_RATE_LIMIT=1` and pointing `KONOHA_AUTH_FILE` elsewhere. Do not set either on a shared host.

15.3 First run

The bootstrap password `konohagakure` is valid until you change it. The login response says so explicitly: `is_bootstrap: true`, `requires_password_change: true`. Treat an unchanged bootstrap password as an open door on any host another person can reach, and change it on first login.

15.4 Secrets at rest

Secret	Storage
Web password	`~/.konoha/web_auth.json`, mode `0600`
Web session secret	`~/.konoha/` token file, mode `0600`
Telegram bot token, webhook secret	`telegram_config` table, AES-256-GCM encrypted
Vault key	`~/.konoha/.vault_key`, 32 random bytes, mode `0600`
Vault key override	`KONOHA_MASTER_KEY`, stretched with scrypt

The vault key is the root of that encryption: whoever reads `.vault_key` and the database can decrypt the Telegram credentials. Back up the key with the database, or lose the ability to restore either.

Masked display strings never overwrite stored credentials: if a configuration update passes a value containing `***` or an ellipsis, the writer preserves the existing secret unchanged.

15.5 Backups contain credentials

`~/.konoha/backups/configs/` holds copies of client MCP configs, and those configs can carry tokens. The directory inherits your umask, not `0600`. If you copy backups into a repository or a share, read them first.

15.6 What the manual will not tell you

Authenticated Web UI screens are documented from route names and navigation labels only. Page contents are behind your session, and reproducing them here would mean reproducing your data. That is a documentation limit, not a redaction.

15.7 Scope

This is an operator's description of the mechanisms in 2.2.20, not a security audit. The audit artefact for the release lives in `docs/SecurityCompliance/`, and the interesting findings there concern dependencies rather than this design.

16. Appendix

16.1 Paths

Path	Contents
`~/.konoha/`	runtime: scripts, `server.js`, `migrate.js`, `migrations/`, `apps/web/`, `assets/`, `patches/`
`~/.konoha/konoha.db` (+ `-wal`, `-shm`)	SQLite database, 33 tables
`~/.konoha/config.json`	overrides for 16.2
`~/.konoha/web_auth.json`	password hash, mode `0600`
`~/.konoha/.vault_key`	AES key for stored secrets, mode `0600`
`~/.konoha/backups/configs/<client>/global/`	SHA-verified config backups
`~/.konoha/{tmp,workflow}`	scratch and task artefacts
`~/.agents/agents.yaml`	agent roster (authoritative)
`~/.agents/skills/`	skill roots picked up by migrate
`~/.gemini/config/mcp_config.json`	Antigravity MCP registration (as read by doctor)
`~/.gemini/antigravity-ide/mcp_config.json`	where init writes it (D11)
`~/.claude.json`	Claude Code MCP servers
`~/.cursor/`, `~/.codex/`, `~/.config/opencode/`, `~/.commandcode/`, `~/.pi/`, `~/.omp/`	per-client registration

16.2 Configuration keys

`~/.konoha/config.json`, read at call time (no caching), so `konoha config set` takes effect immediately. Values below are the compiled defaults.

Key	Default	Meaning
`ui_port`	`1404`	Web UI
`gateway_port`	`19999`	model gateway
`bridge_port`	`1313`	bridge router
`nine_router_port`	`20128`	9router integration
`migrate_time_budget_seconds`	`900`	embedding backfill budget
`install_build_migrate_timeout_ms`	`900000`	install/migrate watchdog
`inference_timeout_ms`	`900000`	model call
`stream_timeout_ms`	`300000`	streamed call
`git_timeout_ms`	`30000`	git operations
`url_timeout_ms`	`20000`	URL probes
`probe_timeout_ms`	`1500`	liveness probe
`ui_ready_timeout_ms`	`180000`	Web UI startup wait
`aislop_gate_timeout_ms`	`180000`	anti-slop scan
`live_glb_poll_timeout_ms`	`15000`	3D live preview
`sqlite_busy_timeout_ms`	`5000`	lock wait
`notify_dedupe_ttl_ms`	`180000`	notification dedupe
`minimum_confidence`	`98`	Kage gate threshold
`skill_top_k`	`5`	skills returned per query
`skill_candidate_k`	`25`	rerank candidates
`semantic_top_k`	`10`	vector hits before rerank

Inspect and change with `konoha config list`, `konoha config get <key>`, `konoha config set <key> <value>`, `konoha config unset <key>`.

16.3 Environment variables

Variable	Effect
`HOST`	Web UI bind address (default `127.0.0.1`)
`KONOHA_BOOTSTRAP_PASSWORD`	overrides the first-run password seed
`KONOHA_SESSION_TTL_MS`	session lifetime (default 12 h)
`KONOHA_AUTH_FILE`	alternate credential file
`KONOHA_DISABLE_RATE_LIMIT`	`1` disables login lockout — tests only
`KONOHA_MASTER_KEY`	vault key override, scrypt-stretched
`KONOHA_SEMANTIC_SEARCH`	`0` disables vector search, leaving FTS5
`KONOHA_HOME`	alternate runtime root
`KONOHA_CLIENT`	forces client identity for setup paths
`NODE_ENV`	`test` disables rate limiting
`FORCE_COLOR`	colour output in pipes

16.4 Defect register

Observed in 2.2.20, recorded rather than fixed. None blocks normal operation.

ID	Defect
D1	`konoha version` says "already running the latest" when your build is ahead of the registry
D2	`konoha test` prints `Total indexed: undefined entries`
D3	`konoha upgrade` cannot resolve an unpublished target version
D4	`konoha tui --help` launches the TUI
D5	`konoha doctor --help` executes doctor
D6	upgrade aborts before modifying anything (fail-closed; recovery in 14.1)
D7	`~/.konoha/bin/konoha` can be a dangling symlink after reinstall
D8	`doctor` and `status` disagree on some sector counts
D9	Akatsuki lab ships incomplete container definitions
D10	a `konoha-mcp/` directory can remain in the global prefix after reinstall
D11	Antigravity config path written by init differs from the one doctor reads
D12	`konoha agent models --help` reports `Subagent "@--help" not found`

16.5 Glossary

Term	Meaning
Agent / ninja	a configured subagent persona with a model and skill list
Skill	reusable instruction bundle, indexed in SQLite, retrieved by intent
Reference	sub-document of a skill, chunked separately
Chunk	embedded unit of a skill or reference (3,421 on a fresh install)
Manifest	`mcp_tool_manifest.json`, the tool contract advertised over MCP
Gate	mandatory checkpoint requiring human approval before work continues
Kage gate	delivery review gate: anti-slop score and confidence threshold
Bounded file tool	MCP read tool that truncates by contract
Baseline	hypothetical full-library byte count used by the savings report

Term	Meaning
Bridge	second-opinion provider route for cross-review

16.6 Version provenance

This manual describes **2.2.20** as present at commit `221f989a` on `master`, which is 18 commits ahead of tag `v2.2.20` and one patch ahead of the newest npm release (`2.2.19`) at the time of writing. Live evidence throughout was produced on Linux against a fresh global install under a scratch prefix.

Known limitations, stated rather than papered over:

- Windows installation is documented but unverified.
- Authenticated Web UI page contents are described from routes and navigation, not screenshots.
- Benchmark percentages are quoted from `docs/architecture/TOKEN-BASELINE.md` and the live `konoha savings` output; read 12.1 before quoting them.